

Statement on the Use of AI

The British Access Network · Introduction to Digital History · Ananya Besufekad

I used AI tools throughout this project, under my own direction, and I take responsibility for all of the final content.

Models and tools

Anthropic's Claude (Opus-class models) for research assistance, coding, and editing and increasing the clarity of drafts; Claude's design feature for the initial website prototype; Claude Code (the command-line coding tool) for refining and extending the site and for the data analysis; and a Claude vision model (claude-opus-4-7) as a transcription tool for the Bank of England's 1890 handwritten Daily Account Books, which I then validated against an independent source.

What I used it for

- **Web design and build.** I generated an initial design and layout for the interactive website with Claude, then refined and extended it with Claude Code, including the interactive panels (the crisis information-flow sequence and the access-network graph). I made the design, content, and structure decisions and reviewed the result.
- **Coding and analysis.** I specified the analyses I wanted (lead-time clocks, the telegraph comparison, the network-centrality analysis, concentration measures) and used AI to help write and debug the Python that produced the figures and tables. I ran the code and checked the outputs.
- **Archival transcription.** The 1890 account books survive only as handwritten images. I used the vision model to transcribe them, then verified every figure I kept against the Bank's Millennium Bank Rate series and a Wednesday-anchor check, and discarded values I could not confirm.
- **Writing.** I used AI to edit the grammar, refine the clarity of the paper and the site as well as revise prose for the paper and the website, working iteratively from my own outline, argument, and corrections. I edited for accuracy and cut anything the evidence did not support.
- **Literature and structure.** I used it to help locate and summarise relevant scholarship, which I then read and verified before citing.
- **Dataset research:** In addition to Claude I used gpt 5.5 for relevant dataset research in the financial sector before deciding on a topic and then framed my topic based on the availability of the data.

Prompting strategy

I worked iteratively rather than in one shot: propose a step, inspect the result, correct it, repeat. I kept the model on a short leash on claims, asking it to flag what the sources could and could not support, and I repeatedly tightened the framing (for example, insisting the project claims dated visibility and access, not foreknowledge or profit).

Specific considerations

My main concern was not overclaiming. I treated AI output as a draft to be checked, not as evidence: code was run and inspected, transcriptions were validated against independent data, and citations were confirmed against the original sources before use.